



ARTICLES OF ASSOCIATION

MIND OVER MATTER

PREAMBLE

We, the students of Kenyatta University, recognizing the unique pressures and challenges of our academic and personal lives, and believing in the fundamental importance of mental well-being, do hereby establish "Mind Over Matter." Our purpose is to build a compassionate and supportive community where mental health matters, is openly discussed, and actively nurtured.

ARTICLE I: NAME

The official name of this organization shall be **Mind Over Matter**.

ARTICLE II: PURPOSE & MISSION

Section 1: Purpose

The primary purpose of the Club is to build a sustainable community where the mental health of all members is valued, protected, and prioritized.

Section 2: Mission

The Club's mission is to:

- a) De-stigmatize mental health issues and foster open, honest, and empathetic conversations.
- b) Provide a supportive network and a safe space for students to connect and share their experiences.
- c) Develop and promote programs, initiatives, and resources that enhance mental wellness and resilience.
- d) Advocate for the well-being of the student body within the greater academic community.



ARTICLE III: LOGO & SYMBOLISM



The official logo of the Club is described as follows:

- **A Circle:** Representing the community, inclusivity, and the continuous nature of support.
- **A Head (Profile):** Representing the people within our community and the individual mind.
- **A Green Bud:** Representing mental health, growth, renewal, and positive well-being.
- **The Name "Mind Over Matter":** Placed prominently to identify the Club and its guiding principle.

ARTICLE IV: CORE VALUES

The Club shall be guided by the following core values:

- **Empathy:** Seeking to understand and share the feelings of others without judgment.
- **Community:** Fostering a sense of belonging, connection, and mutual support.
- **Confidentiality:** Creating a safe and trusted space for all members.
- **Inclusivity:** Welcoming and respecting all individuals, regardless of background, identity, or experience.
- **Advocacy:** Proactively championing the cause of mental well-being for all students.
- **Growth:** Encouraging personal and collective development in understanding and managing mental health.



ARTICLE V: MEMBERSHIP

Membership shall be open to all students currently enrolled in the Kenyatta University.

ARTICLE VI: GOVERNANCE & STRUCTURE

The governing body of the Club shall consist of the Executive Committee and the Class Representative Council.

Section 1: The Executive Committee

The Executive Committee shall be the principal leadership and administrative body of the Club, composed of:

- a) The Chairperson
- b) The Vice Chairperson, Administration & Finance
- c) The Vice Chairperson Public Relations & Communications.
- d) The Vice Chairperson, Programs & Initiatives
- e) The Vice Chairperson, Strategic Development & Partnerships
- f) Voting Representative (Lower Classes: Years 1-3)
- g) Voting Representative (Upper Classes: Years 4-6)

Section 2: The Class Representatives

- a) A council of six (6) representatives shall be established, with one representative elected or appointed from each of the six (6) medical classes (Year 1 through to year 6).
- b) This council serves as a direct link between the Executive Committee and the student body, ensuring all cohorts are represented.

Section 3: Ex Officio Member

The Standing Committee on Mental Health (SCOMH) Local Officer shall serve as a non-voting, ex officio member of the Executive Committee to ensure alignment and collaboration with national (MSAKE) and international (IFMSA) bodies. The ex officio member shall be non-voting, except in the instance of a tie, in which case they shall cast the deciding vote.

Section 4: Patron

The Executive Committee shall have the provision to appoint a Patron, typically a faculty



member or esteemed professional, who shall serve as an advisor and mentor to the Club.

ARTICLE VII: FUNCTIONS OF THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Section 1: The Chairperson

- a) Serves as the official head and chief representative of the Club.
- b) Presides over all Executive Committee and General Meetings.
- c) Provides strategic direction and leadership for the Club.
- d) Acts as the primary liaison between the Club and high level External partners.

Section 2: The Vice Chairperson, Administration & Finance

- a) Acts as the chief administrative officer, responsible for human resources, member records, and internal organization.
- b) Manages all financial affairs of the Club, including budgeting, bookkeeping, and financial reporting.
- c) Assumes the duties of the Chairperson in their absence.

Section 3: The Vice Chairperson, Programs & Initiatives

- a) Oversees the planning and execution of all internal Club events, workshops, and awareness campaigns.
- b) Manages the logistical requirements for all approved programs and events.
- c) Leads and coordinates the teams responsible for program delivery and member engagement.
- d) Collaborates with the VC, Strategic Development to successfully implement new projects and initiatives.

Section 4 : The Vice Chairperson, Public Relations & Communications

- a) Acts as Chief spokesperson for the club in external forums.
- b) Oversees public relations and crisis communication strategies .
- c) Manager Manager all official organization communication channels including website, email and social media platform.
- d) Leads social media team and is responsible for content creation and dissemination.
- e) Ensures that all outward-facing messaging is empathetic, inclusive, and consistent with the Club's Core Values.



Section 5: The Vice Chairperson, Strategic Development & Initiatives

- a) Leads the creation, development, and implementation of new long-term programs and strategic initiatives.
- b) Conducts needs assessments and gathers feedback to ensure Club activities are relevant and impactful.
- c) Manages the implementation and logistical rollout of all new projects.
- d) Collaborates with all VCs to ensure programs are well-integrated, financed, and communicated.
- e) Identifies and cultivates relationships with potential strategic partners (e.g., NGOs, professional mental health bodies) to enhance Club offerings.
- f) Manages the transition of approved initiatives to the VC, Programs & Initiatives for execution.

Section 5: The Voting Representatives (Lower & Upper Classes)

- a) Are elected from the Class Representative Council (one from Years 1-3, one from Years 4-6).
- b) Serve as full voting members of the Executive Committee, bringing the perspective of the student body to leadership decisions.
- c) Are responsible for chairing the Class Representative Council meetings.

ARTICLE VIII: APPOINTMENTS & VOTING

Section 1: Appointment of Executive Officers

As of the adoption of these articles, Executive Committee members shall be appointed rather than elected.

- a) Vacant positions shall be filled through a process of nomination, which may be opened to the general membership.
- b) Nominees must be approved by a simple majority vote of the existing Executive Committee.

Section 2: Decision Making & Voting

- a) All proposals or matters requiring a decision shall be tabled at an Executive Committee



meeting.

b) Each voting member of the Executive Committee (as defined in Article VI, Section 1) shall have one (1) vote.

c) A simple majority vote is required to pass a motion, provided quorum is met.

d) In the event of a tie, the ex officio member shall cast the deciding vote.

Section 3: Removal from Office.

An Executive Committee member may be removed from office for the following reasons:

a) Resignation: A formal resignation is tendered with at least two (2) weeks' written notice to the Chairperson.

b) Vote of No Confidence: A motion of no confidence is passed by a simple majority of the remaining voting members of the Executive Committee.

c) Failure to Uphold Standards: This includes, but is not limited to, excessive absenteeism (as defined in Article X), failure to fulfill the duties of the office, or violation of the Club's Core Values.

d) Gross Misconduct: Involvement in any serious ethical, financial, or behavioral violation deemed detrimental to the reputation and function of the Club.

ARTICLE IX: FISCAL & PROGRAM YEAR

The Fiscal Year and Program Year of the Club shall commence on September 1st and conclude on August 31st of the following year.

ARTICLE X: MEETINGS

Section 1: Regular Meetings

The Executive Committee shall hold at least one (1) regular meeting per month to plan activities for the subsequent month and report reading for previous events.

Section 2: Ad Hoc Meetings

a) Ad hoc meetings may be called by the Chairperson or upon the written request of any two (2) members of the Executive Committee.

b) A notice of at least forty-eight (48) hours must be given to all members for any ad hoc meeting, specifying its purpose.



Section 3: Attendance

- a) Members of the Executive Committee are expected to attend all scheduled meetings.
- b) Any member who misses two (2) consecutive meetings without a formal apology shall be subject to review by the Executive Committee.
- c) Any member who misses more than three (3) consecutive meetings, even with an apology, shall be liable for questioning by the Executive Committee regarding their commitment and capacity to serve.

Section 4: Quorum

Quorum for an Executive Committee meeting shall be 50% + 1 of its voting members. No official vote may be taken if quorum is not met.

ARTICLE XI: AMENDMENTS

Section 1: Proposing Amendments

Any voting member of the Executive Committee may propose an amendment to these Articles of Association by tabling a formal proposition at a regular or ad hoc Executive Committee meeting.

Section 2: Voting & Adoption

- a) A proposed amendment shall be subject to the normal terms of decision making as defined in Article VIII, Section 2.
- b) The amendment must be discussed and voted upon by the Executive Committee.
- c) A simple majority vote of the Executive Committee is required to adopt the amendment.
- d) In the event of a tie, the ex officio member shall cast the deciding vote.



Signatures.

Chairperson : _____

VC Administration : _____

VC Programs & Initiatives : _____

VC Strategic Development : _____

VC public relations & communication: _____